1. Aral Sea
2. Black Sea
3. Lake Baikal

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3
(c) 2 only (d) 1 and 3

Ans. (a): The Aral Sea is a saline lake located in central Asia, once the world's fourth-largest salt lake. In the 1960's the Aral sea, which was the drainage basin for Kyrgyzstan, Turkmenistan, Tajikistan, Uzbekistan, Pakistan, Afghanistan and Kazakhstan, began to shrink as the Soviet Union began to divert water for agricultural purposes. The Aral sea, which was once 26,300 square miles in size, decreased in size by 2007 to only 10% of its original area. Lake Baikal, the water level has gone below the critical mark of 456m eleven times since 1962. Lake Baikal shows more of a fluctuating regime and shrinkage is not comparable to that of Aral Sea. So the correct answer is option (a) Aral Sea.

POPULATION AND URBANIZATION

28. Among the following cities, which one lies on a longitude closest to that of Delhi?

(a) Bengaluru (b) Hyderabad
(c) Nagpur (d) Pune

Ans. (a): The longitude of Delhi is 77° East and Bengaluru lies close to Delhi in terms of longitude. Hyderabad and Nagpur are further on the East.

Cities	North Latitude	East Latitude
Delhi	28.7041° N	77.1025° E
Bengaluru	12.9716° N	77.5946° E
Hyderabad	17.3850° N	78.4867° E
Nagpur	21.1458° N	79.0882° E
Pune	18.5204° N	73.8567° E

So the correct answer is option (a).

Indian Constitution and Polity

• Constitutional Development of India

29. In the Federation established by The Government of India Act of 1935, residuary powers were given to the ?

(a) Federal Legislature
(b) Governor General
(c) Provincial Legislature
(d) Provincial Governors

Ans. (b) : The residuary power was not allocated either to the Federation or to the provinces but was under section 105 of the Government of India. Act of 1935 reserved to be allocated by the Governor -General in his discretion to the federation or to the provinces.

• Citizenship, Fundamental Rights, Fundamental Duties, Directive Principles of State Policies

30. Consider the following statements:

1. **As per the Right to Education (RTE) Act, to be eligible for appointment as a teacher in a State, a person would be required to possess the minimum qualification laid down by the concerned State Council of Teacher Education.**
2. **As per the RTE Act, for teaching primary classes, a candidate is required to pass a Teacher Eligibility Test conducted in accordance with the National Council of Teacher Education guidelines.**
3. **In India, more than 90% of teacher education institutions are directly under the State Governments.**

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 (b) 2 only
(c) 1 and 3 (d) 3 only

Ans. (b): In accordance with the provisions of sub-section (1) of section 23 of the Right of Children to Free and Compulsory Education (RTE) Act, 2009, the National Council for Teacher Education (NCTE) has laid down the minimum qualifications for a person to be eligible for appointment as a teacher in class 1 to 8 vide its Notification dated 23 August, 2010. So Statement (1) is not correct.

- One of the essential qualifications for a person to be eligible for appointment as a teacher in any of the primary schools is that he/she should pass the Teacher Eligibility Test (TET) which will be conducted by the appropriate government. So, statement (2) is correct.
- From the mid-1960s to 1993, the number of TETs in India went up from about 1200 to about 1500. After the NCTE was set up, the number of TETs exploded, to about 16,000 (over 90% private) by 2011. So statement (3) is not correct.

31. Which one of the following reflects the most appropriate relationship between law and liberty?

(a) If there are more laws, there is less liberty.
(b) If there are no laws, there is no liberty.
(c) If there is liberty, laws have to be made by the people.
(d) If laws are changed too often, liberty is in danger.

Ans. (b): The term 'Liberty' means the absence of restraints on the activities of individuals and at the same time, providing opportunities for the development of individuals. However, liberty does not mean 'license' to do what one likes and has to be enjoyed within the limitations mentioned in the constitution and various laws. Therefore, the concept of liberty is not absolute. The absence of laws does not ensure liberty.
Liberty entails the responsible use of freedom under the rule of law without depriving anyone else of their freedom. Freedom is broader in that it represents a total lack of restraint or the unrestrained ability to fulfill one's desires.
The correct answer is option (b)

32. Which of the following are regarded as the main features of the "Rule of Law" ?

1. Limitation of powers
2. Equality before law
3. People's responsibility to the Government
4. Liberty and civil rights

Which of the statements given above are correct?

(a) 1 and 3 only (b) 2 and 4 only
(c) 1, 2 and 4 only (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Ans. (c) : The concept of the rule of the law is a very dynamic concept capable of interpretations to enable the successful working of a democracy. It is the restriction on the arbitrary exercise of power by subordinating it to well-defined and established laws. Features of the modern meaning of the rule of law–
1. Certainty of the law.
2. Supremacy of the law.
3. Equality before the law.
4. Right to personal freedom
5. Laws must not take retrospective effect
6. Independent judiciary.
7. Protection of human rights.
Therefore the correct answer is option (c)

33. Right to Privacy is protected as an intrinsic part of Right to Life and Personal Liberty. Which of the following in the Constitution of India correctly and appropriately imply the above statement ?

(a) Article 14 and the provisions under the 42nd Amendment to the Constitution
(b) Article 17 and the Directive Principles of State Policy in Part IV
(c) Article 21 and the freedoms guaranteed in Part III
(d) Article 24 and the provisions under the 44th Amendment to the Constitution

Ans. (c): Article 21 guarantees the right to life and personal liberty under part III of the constitution. The historic fallout of the nine-judge Bench judgment declaring privacy an inherent right protected by part III of the constitution, is that an ordinary man can now directly approach the Supreme Court and the High Court to violate his fundamental right under the constitution.
By making privacy an intrinsic part of life and liberty under Article 21, it is not just a citizen but anyone, whether an Indian national or not, can move the constitutional courts of the land under Article 32 and 226, respectively to get justice.
So, the correct answer is option (c)

• Executive of Center and States, Emergency Provisions

34. With reference to the election of the President of India, consider the following statements :

1. **The value of the vote of each MLA varies from State to State.**
2. **The value of the vote of MPs of the Lok Sabha is more than the value of the vote of MPs of the Rajya Sabha.**

Which of the statements given above is/are correct ?

(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (a) : Value of a vote and securing parity.
(a) Article 55 provides for uniformity in the scale of representation of different states at the election of the president.
(b) Besides there should also be a parity between the states as a whole and the union.
(c) For this purpose the value of votes of an MLA and an MP is counted under the following formula.
(1) Value of an MLA Vote

$$= \frac{\text{Total Population of the State / UT}}{\text{Total Number of elected members of the state Legislative Assembly}} \times \frac{1}{1000}$$

(2) Value of an MP Vote =

$$\frac{\text{The Sum of Vote Value of elected members of all the states}}{\text{The Sum of elected members of both the houses of Parliament}}$$

The value of the vote of each MP of Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha is equal, i.e, 708 total value of the current strength of Lok Sabha MPs is 3,84,444 and Rajya Sabha (233) total value is 1, 64,964.
The value of the vote of each MLA of each state is different. It is determined by the average constituency size and 1971 census. The value of MLA of Uttar Pradesh is the highest, i.e, 208.
So, the correct answer is option (a)

35. If the President of India exercises his power as provided under Article 356 of the Constitution in respect of a particular State, then

(a) the Assembly of the State is automatically dissolved.
(b) the powers of the Legislature of that State shall be exercisable by or under the authority of the Parliament.
(c) Article 19 is suspended in that State.
(d) the President can make laws relating to that State.

Ans. (b) : Article 356- Provisions in case of failure of constitutional machinery in state-
(i) If the President on receipt of the report from the Governor of the state or otherwise is satisfied that a situation has arisen in which the government of the state cannot be carried on in accordance with the provisions of this constitution, the President may be Proclamation.
(a) Assume to himself all or any of the functions of the Government of the state and all or any of the powers vested in or exercisable by the Governor or anybody or authority in the state other than the Legislature of the state;
(b) Declare that the powers of the Legislature of the state shall be exercisable by or under the authority or Parliament;
So the correct answer is option (b).